

2560x1440 goodness

Dell's new 27-inch 16:9 Ultrasharp U2711 makes some noise on the internet

Core i goes cheap

Intel's Core i3 530 processor hit the market at an affordable \$125

Agent 001

Q I want to buy a desktop under Rs. 35,000. I have looked for many and narrowed down on the IdeaCenter B500. Can I get a better assembled PC under my budget. If yes, can you please send me a list of its configuration. I will be used for programming and watching movies and also for some occasional gaming.

Shubham Kesarwani

A You can build a much better assembled PC. Here is my suggested configuration for under Rs. 35,000.

	Components	Price (in Rs.)
Processor	AMD Athlon 2 X4 620	5,050
Motherboard	Gigabyte MA78GM-US2H	4,200
RAM	2 x 1 GB DDR2 800 MHz (Kingston)	2,000
Graphics Card	Zotac GeForce 9600GT	4,750
Hard Drive	Seagate 500 GB 7200.11	3,100
Hard Drive 2	-	-
Monitor	AOC 2236Vw	8,400
Sound Card	None	-
Cabinet	Zebtronics Antibiotic	2,100
Power Supply	VIP 400W Gold	850
Speakers	-	-
Keyboard	Logitech Multimedia	400
Mouse	Logitech 3 button scroll	300
	Total	31,150

Q I am planning to buy a new video card. My budget is Rs. 10,000. Please suggest a video card from NVIDIA. I don't want to buy a card from ATI. Thanks in advance! Great work!

Barath Pandian

A: I would have recommended the ATI Radeon HD 5770, but you have mentioned that you don't want ATI. In that case look for the NVIDIA GTS 250 for around 8K. If you can spend a little more, the GTX 260 for Rs. 12,500 will be quite a bit faster. Brands to look at are ZOTAC, XFX, Palit and ASUS.

Q I have few queries regarding sound card. I have recently purchased a PC with the following configurations: Motherboard: Biostar G41D-M7 Processor: Intel Core2Duo E7500 GPU: XFX 9800GT 512 MB RAM: 2 x 2 GB Kingston DDR2 800Mhz I have bought myself a 5.1 Speaker. It's iBall Speaker Booster. I would

mostly use it for gaming and watching movies. It does not have a great deal of surround effect.

I wanted to know if adding a sound card will do justice?

I have a limited budget of around Rs. 3,200. I was looking for ASUS Xonar DX. Is there any better option in this budget? I want to know what kind of performance increment will I get to see using this card.

Rimo Paul

A There is no performance increment to be seen when using a sound card. At least, not one that is definitely measurable. But any good sound card uses better quality components and delivers a generally better quality, more neutral sound. By more neutral, I mean a sound that has no exaggeration of any particular frequency i.e. bass, mid-range and treble, but reproduces in an unbiased manner. I do not think you will see a huge difference in your sound quality simply because you have purchased very mediocre speakers. Something like an Altec Lansing MX 5021 will definitely benefit from a good sound card. In general, when using good speakers, the sound quality will be better, you will also get slightly higher volumes at the same volume setting.

Q Can you please recommend a smart phone (not business type) within the range of Rs. 15,000 to Rs. 25,000. It should have a minimum 5 MP camera with maximum resolution, a multi-touch screen, good long lasting battery with minimum 8 GB expandable memory and 3G. Thank you

Stanzin Namgyal

A You might want to take a look at Sony Ericsson's new Satio. It's priced around the Rs. 28,000 mark, but you may be able to find some really nice deals on the street. It meets all your criteria.

Q I am planning to buy a new CPU and motherboard within Rs. 18,000. I need it for playing CPU hungry games such as GTA-4 and Crysis. Is Core i5 750 + Gigabyte GA-P55M-UD2 a good combo?

Also, can CoolerMaster 460W extreme power handle quad-core CPU? My current system configuration as follows: Intel Pentium IV 3 GHz 630 processor Intel 915GEV motherboard XFX 9600GT 512MB graphic card 1GB DDR 2 + 512 MB RAM 500 GB WD Green Edition + Seagate 250 GB SATA HDDs Coolermaster 460W Extreme power PSU

Satpal Singh

A Remember that you will also need DDR3 RAM, which will also cost Rs. 2,500 for 2 GB. The combination of processor and motherboard is good. It will see you through the next 2-3 years. If you could consider spending more and getting the Core i7 860, which would cost around Rs. 4,500 more. I also recommend upgrading that power supply to at least a Corsair VX 450 that will cost you Rs. 3,600.

Q Which is world's best performer high speed 32 GB pendrive

Bhaumik Gohel

A Look for Corsair's Voyager GT 32 GB or OCZs ATV 32 GB. These are the fast ones available in India. Kingston's HyperX 32 GB is also available, but it's very costly, at least double the price of the other two mentioned here.

Q I want to buy a digital camera in the price range of Rs. 8,000 - Rs. 12,000. I want it primarily for capturing photos (indoors) of spectacular picture quality which is crystal clear even in low light conditions. The camera must have good overall performance. I've decided on the Canon IXUS 100 IS. Have I made the right choice? Please tell me about the best within the criteria I mentioned above.

Neelkamal

A You may want to look at Canon's PowerShot SX 110IS and SX 120IS for better performance in low light, owing to slightly larger sensors. Just note that crystal clear clarity in low-light conditions is not possible even with some high-end dSLRs. But both these cameras are more detailed than the IXUS you have mentioned and will offer more manual controls. **d**